

THE STONE AGE: PALAEOLITHIC & MESOLITHIC

STONE AGE CHRONOLOGICAL-CLIMATIC SPINE → STONE IS A BEHAVIOURAL → LITHIC SYSTEMS COMPARED → INDIAN SITE MAP: REGION → MOBILITY-SUBSISTENCE-SOCIAL LOOP → ROCK ART AND SYMBOLIC

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g10 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

STONE AGE CHRONOLOGICAL-CLIMATIC SPINE

STONE AGE CHRONOLOGICAL-CLIMATIC SPINE

PLEISTOCENE HOLOCENE

LOWER PALAEOLITHIC

MIDDLE PALAEOLITHIC

UPPER PALAEOLITHIC

MESOLITHIC HANDAXE/CLEAVER FLAKES/PREPARED CORES BLADES/BONE/ART MICROLITHS MOBILE LANDSCAPES FLEXIBLE

TRANSITIONS ARE REGIONALLY STAGGERED; TOOL CHANGE IS NOT A

PLEISTOCENE HOLOCENE

Lower Palaeolithic → Middle Palaeolithic → Upper Palaeolithic → Mesolithic handaxe/cleaver flakes/prepared cores blades/bone/art microliths

reduction wider symbolism diverse niches

Transitions are regionally staggered; tool change is not a single species timetable.

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

• PLEISTOCENE HOLOCENE

• Lower Palaeolithic → Middle Palaeolithic → Upper Palaeolithic → Mesolithic handaxe/cleaver flakes/prepared cores blades/bone/art microliths mobile landscapes flexible

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

• reduction wider symbolism diverse niches

• Transitions are regionally staggered; tool change is not a single species timetable.

IMPACT / LIMIT

• PLEISTOCENE HOLOCENE

• Lower Palaeolithic → Middle Palaeolithic → Upper Palaeolithic → Mesolithic handaxe/cleaver flakes/prepared cores blades/bone/art microliths mobile landscapes flexible

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Transitions are regionally staggered; tool change is not a single species timetable.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Transitions are regionally staggered; tool change is not a single species timetable.

01

STAGE 01

STONE IS A BEHAVIOURAL ARCHIVE

STONE IS A BEHAVIOURAL ARCHIVE

RAW-MATERIAL NODULE

CORE REDUCTION

TOOL USE

DISCARD SOURCE DISTANCE SKILL/PLANNING EDGE DAMAGE ACTIVITY AREA

ASSEMBLAGE + STRATIGRAPHY + DATING + PALAEOENVIRONMENT

BEHAVIOURAL INFERENCE

A LABELLED TOOL WITHOUT CONTEXT CANNOT ESTABLISH AGE, SPECIES

RAW-MATERIAL NODULE → CORE REDUCTION → FLAKE/BLADE → TOOL USE → DISCARD source distance skill/planning

ASSEMBLAGE + STRATIGRAPHY + DATING + PALAEOENVIRONMENT → BEHAVIOURAL INFERENCE

A labelled tool without context cannot establish age, species or complete lifeway.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

• RAW-MATERIAL NODULE → CORE REDUCTION → FLAKE/BLADE → TOOL USE → DISCARD source distance skill/planning edge damage activity area

• ASSEMBLAGE + STRATIGRAPHY + DATING + PALAEOENVIRONMENT → BEHAVIOURAL INFERENCE

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

• A labelled tool without context cannot establish age, species or complete lifeway.

• RAW-MATERIAL NODULE → CORE REDUCTION → FLAKE/BLADE → TOOL USE → DISCARD source distance skill/planning edge damage activity area

DEBATE / LEGACY

• ASSEMBLAGE + STRATIGRAPHY + DATING + PALAEOENVIRONMENT → BEHAVIOURAL INFERENCE

• A labelled tool without context cannot establish age, species or complete lifeway.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — A labelled tool without context cannot establish age, species or complete lifeway.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A labelled tool without context cannot establish age, species or complete lifeway.

02

STAGE 02

LITHIC SYSTEMS COMPARED

LITHIC SYSTEMS COMPARED

LOWER MIDDLE UPPER MESOLITHIC BIFACES, CLEAVERS FLAKE TOOLS BLADES

TECHNOLOGY RECORDS CHOICES; OLDER TECHNIQUES MAY PERSIST BESIDE NEWER

GROWTH HAFTED COMPOSITES QUARTZITE COMMON RAW-MATERIAL ECONOMY SYMBOLIC EVIDENCE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
LOWER MIDDLE UPPER MESOLITHIC bifaces, cleavers flake tools blades, burins geometric microliths large cutting tools prepared-core planning bone/ornament	Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones.	growth hafted composites quartzite common raw-material economy symbolic evidence bow/sickle/barb uses
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POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

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EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

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DEBATE / LEGACY

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• Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones.

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MECHANISM / VERDICT — A labelled tool without context cannot establish age, species or complete lifeway.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A labelled tool without context cannot establish age, species or complete lifeway.

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MECHANISM / VERDICT — Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones.

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03

STAGE 03

INDIAN SITE MAP: REGION, SITE, SIGNIFICANCE

INDIAN SITE MAP

REGION, SITE, SIGNIFICANCE

SOAN VALLEY

RIVER-TERRACE LITHICS AND SEQUENCE DEBATES

BELAN VALLEY

LONG PREHISTORIC SEQUENCE TOWARD FOOD PRODUCTION

SHELTERS/ROCK ART

MESOLITHIC EVIDENCE

NORTH: Belan valley → long prehistoric sequence toward food production

CENTRAL: Bhimbetka → shelters/rock art

Adamgarh → Mesolithic evidence

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

• NORTH-WEST: Soan valley → river-terrace lithics and sequence debates

• NORTH: Belan valley → long prehistoric sequence toward food production

• CENTRAL: Bhimbetka → shelters/rock art

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

• Adamgarh → Mesolithic evidence

• WEST: Bagor → Mesolithic settlement, subsistence and domestication debate

• GANGA PLAIN: Sarai Nahar Rai, Mahadaha, Damdama → burials and sedentism

DEBATE / LEGACY

• SOUTH: Attirampakkam → early Acheulian and Middle Palaeolithic chronology

• DECCAN: Hunsgi-Baichbal → quarry, factory and landscape organisation

MECHANISM / VERDICT — DECCAN: Hunsgi-Baichbal → quarry, factory and landscape organisation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DECCAN: Hunsgi-Baichbal → quarry, factory and landscape organisation.

04

STAGE 04

MOBILITY-SUBSISTENCE-SOCIAL LOOP

MOBILITY-SUBSISTENCE-SOCIAL LOOP

SEASONAL RESOURCES

MOVEMENT SCHEDULE

CAMP TYPE

TOOL KIT

SHARING NETWORK GAME, FISH, PLANTS BASE/SPECIAL CAMP HEARTHS PORTABLE/COMPOSITE

REPEATED OCCUPATION AND STORAGE MAY INCREASE WITHOUT FULL FARMING

BURIALS SHOW TREATMENT OF PERSONS; RANK NEEDS PATTERNED UNEQUAL

SEASONAL RESOURCES → MOVEMENT SCHEDULE → CAMP TYPE → TOOL KIT → SHARING NETWORK game

Repeated occupation and storage may increase without full farming or permanent villages.

Burials show treatment of persons; rank needs patterned unequal evidence.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

• SEASONAL RESOURCES → MOVEMENT SCHEDULE → CAMP TYPE → TOOL KIT → SHARING NETWORK game, fish, plants base/special camp hearths portable/composite

• Repeated occupation and storage may increase without full farming or permanent villages.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

• Burials show treatment of persons; rank needs patterned unequal evidence.

• SEASONAL RESOURCES → MOVEMENT SCHEDULE → CAMP TYPE → TOOL KIT → SHARING NETWORK game, fish, plants base/special camp hearths portable/composite

DEBATE / LEGACY

• Repeated occupation and storage may increase without full farming or permanent villages.

• Burials show treatment of persons; rank needs patterned unequal evidence.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Burials show treatment of persons; rank needs patterned unequal evidence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Burials show treatment of persons; rank needs patterned unequal evidence.

05

STAGE 05

ROCK ART AND SYMBOLIC LIFE: INFERENCE LADDER

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DECCAN: Hunsgi-Baichbal → quarry, factory and landscape organisation.

04

STAGE 04 MOBILITY-SUBSISTENCE-SOCIAL LOOP

MOBILITY-SUBSISTENCE-SOCIAL LOOP SEASONAL RESOURCES MOVEMENT SCHEDULE CAMP TYPE TOOL KIT SHARING NETWORK GAME, FISH, PLANTS BASE/SPECIAL CAMP HEARTHS PORTABLE/COMPOSITE REPEATED OCCUPATION AND STORAGE MAY INCREASE WITHOUT FULL FARMING

BURIALS SHOW TREATMENT OF PERSONS; RANK NEEDS PATTERNED UNEQUAL

SEASONAL RESOURCES → MOVEMENT SCHEDULE → CAMP TYPE → TOOL KIT → SHARING NETWORK game

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POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- SEASONAL RESOURCES → MOVEMENT SCHEDULE → CAMP TYPE → TOOL KIT → SHARING NETWORK game, fish, plants base/special camp hearths portable/composite
- Repeated occupation and storage may increase without full farming or permanent villages.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Burials show treatment of persons; rank needs patterned unequal evidence.
- SEASONAL RESOURCES → MOVEMENT SCHEDULE → CAMP TYPE → TOOL KIT → SHARING NETWORK game, fish, plants base/special camp hearths portable/composite

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Repeated occupation and storage may increase without full farming or permanent villages.
- Burials show treatment of persons; rank needs patterned unequal evidence.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Burials show treatment of persons; rank needs patterned unequal evidence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Burials show treatment of persons; rank needs patterned unequal evidence.

05

STAGE 05 ROCK ART AND SYMBOLIC LIFE: INFERENCE LADDER

ROCK ART AND SYMBOLIC LIFE INFERENCE LADDER PIGMENT/ENGRAVING + SUPERIMPOSITION + MOTIF + SHELTER CONTEXT SECURE IMAGE, TECHNIQUE, RELATIVE SEQUENCE AND DEMONSTRATED ASSOCIATION PROBABLE HUNTING, DANCE, GROUP ACTION, ANIMALS AND CHANGING STYLE UNCERTAIN

EXACT MYTH, DEITY, ARTIST IDENTITY OR DIRECT RITUAL MEANING ART EXPANDS BEHAVIOURAL EVIDENCE BUT IS NOT ILLUSTRATED SCRIPTURE.

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- PIGMENT/ENGRAVING + SUPERIMPOSITION + MOTIF + SHELTER CONTEXT secure: image, technique, relative sequence and demonstrated association probable: hunting.
- dance, group action, animals and changing style uncertain: exact myth, deity, artist identity or direct ritual meaning

METHOD / DEBATE

- VERDICT: art expands behavioural evidence but is not illustrated scripture.
- PIGMENT/ENGRAVING + SUPERIMPOSITION + MOTIF + SHELTER CONTEXT secure: image, technique, relative sequence and demonstrated association probable: hunting.

HISTORICAL RESULT

- dance, group action, animals and changing style uncertain: exact myth, deity, artist identity or direct ritual meaning
- VERDICT: art expands behavioural evidence but is not illustrated scripture.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: art expands behavioural evidence but is not illustrated scripture.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: art expands behavioural evidence but is not illustrated scripture.

06

STAGE 06 MESOLITHIC TRANSITION: ADAPTATION, NOT REVOLUTION

MESOLITHIC TRANSITION ADAPTATION, NOT REVOLUTION HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES SMALL GAME/FISH/PLANT NICHES + UNEVEN PATHWAYS TOWARD NEOLITHIC PRODUCTION

HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal

selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps
- selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps
- selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

DEBATE / LEGACY

- HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps
- selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

MECHANISM / VERDICT — HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production.

07

STAGE 07 LIMITS AND CURRENT RESEARCH

LIMITS AND CURRENT RESEARCH SPARSE FOSSILS + DISTURBED SITES + BROAD TOOL LABELS FALSE SHORTCUTS ONE TOOL ONE PEOPLE DATE CONTEXTS, RECONSTRUCT REDUCTION SEQUENCE, COMPARE REGIONS, STATE CONFIDENCE

REFINED CHRONOMETRY AND LANDSCAPE STUDY CAN REVISE EARLY DATES. INDIAN PREHISTORY IS A MOSAIC OF LONG CONTINUITY AND

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- PROBLEM: sparse fossils + disturbed sites + broad tool labels + uncertain associations
- FALSE SHORTCUTS: one tool = one people

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- burial = hierarchy
- RESPONSE: date contexts, reconstruct reduction sequence, compare regions, state confidence

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

MESOLITHIC TRANSITIONADAPTATION, NOT REVOLUTIONHOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES SMALL GAME/FISH/PLANT NICHES +UNEVEN PATHWAYS TOWARD NEOLITHIC PRODUCTION

HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal

selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps
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EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps
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DEBATE / LEGACY

- HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps
- selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

MECHANISM / VERDICT —

HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production.

STAGE 07LIMITS AND CURRENT RESEARCH

LIMITS AND CURRENT RESEARCHSPARSE FOSSILS + DISTURBED SITES + BROAD TOOL LABELSFALSE SHORTCUTSONE TOOLONE PEOPLEDATE CONTEXTS, RECONSTRUCT REDUCTION SEQUENCE, COMPARE REGIONS, STATE CONFIDENCE

REFINED CHRONOMETRY AND LANDSCAPE STUDY CAN REVISE EARLY DATES.INDIAN PREHISTORY IS A MOSAIC OF LONG CONTINUITY AND

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- PROBLEM: sparse fossils + disturbed sites + broad tool labels + uncertain associations
- FALSE SHORTCUTS: one tool = one people
- innovation = migration

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- burial = hierarchy
- RESPONSE: date contexts, reconstruct reduction sequence, compare regions, state confidence
- Refined chronometry and landscape study can revise early dates.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

MECHANISM / VERDICT —

VERDICT: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

STAGE 08STONE AGE ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

STONE AGE ANSWER ARCHITECTURE10 MARKSDDEFINE PHASEDIAGNOSTIC TECHNOLOGYTWO SITES15 MARKSLITHIC COMPARISONSYMBOLIC EVIDENCE

10 MARKS: define phase → diagnostic technology → two sites → subsistence → caution

15 MARKS: chronology → lithic comparison → ecology/mobility → symbolic evidence → limits

20 MARKS: geological frame → methods → four-stage technology → regional site map

economy/social life → Mesolithic transition → historiographical verdict

MUST DISTINGUISH: relative/absolute date; artefact/assemblage; microlith/sedentism.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 10 MARKS: define phase → diagnostic technology → two sites → subsistence → caution
- 15 MARKS: chronology → lithic comparison → ecology/mobility → symbolic evidence → limits

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 20 MARKS: geological frame → methods → four-stage technology → regional site map
- economy/social life → Mesolithic transition → historiographical verdict

DEBATE / LEGACY

- MUST DISTINGUISH: relative/absolute date; artefact/assemblage; microlith/sedentism.
- CLOSE: technology records adaptive choices, not a uniform evolutionary ladder.

MECHANISM / VERDICT —

economy/social life → Mesolithic transition → historiographical verdict

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: economy/social life → Mesolithic transition → historiographical verdict.

EXTRASUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEAS2. KEY CLASSIFICATION3. STUDY LINKS4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)5. UPSC TRAPS6. CURRENT LINK7. MAINS ANGLES

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data
- 3. Study links

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link
- 7. Mains angles

LEGACY / NUANCE

- She discusses Lower, Middle and Upper Palaeolithic sites separately, including tool types and manufacturing contexts.
- Isampur is treated as a centre of stone-tool manufacture.
- Middle Palaeolithic discussions include Attirampakkam and the Levallois technique.
- Mesolithic levels can yield animal bones and pottery; some claims of domesticated cattle, sheep, goat, dog and pig are questioned.

OPTIONAL STATUS —

This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels

THE STONE AGE: PALAEOLITHIC & MESOLITHIC • TILE 4/4 • same master rows 6137-9371 of 9371 • end